

Module II: Communication Skills for Career Building

- CV and Résumé Writing, Interview Skills, Group Discussion,
- Effective Profiling,
- Communication and Networking: Building relationships,
- Seminar & Conference Paper Writing,
- Expert Technical Lecture: Writing and Presenting.
- Writing the Statement of Purpose (SOP) for admission in Higher Studies,

C.V. / Résumé Writing:

In modern world of science and technology, resume writing has become an art. In simple terms, resume or curriculum vitae is an extract or selective record of one's achievements including education, work, experience, qualification, abilities and so on. As a CV reflects the complete achievements of a person in various fields, it enables the employer to form some idea about the proficiency of the applicant.

Difference between CV and Résumé

Curriculum Vitaé mean record or course of your life in Latin. It is a document giving details of the qualifications and the jobs you have had in the past that you send to someone when you are applying for a job. It is CV is detailed, complete and in reverse chronological order record of your professional history. It contains your full introduction. It could be of 3-10 pages.

Résumé is a summary of something. It is your brief introduction of 1-2 pages. It contains Information/ introduction/ experience as per relevant to the job requirement. It is shorter, more focused and targeted list of relevant skills and accomplishment. It is more related to non-academic life.

Why CV / Résumé important

- Recruiters if receive around 100 CVs.
- Have to select only 1.
- Less time to review your CV.
- Around 20 to 60 seconds to read a CV.
- The initial impression is important.

Parts of CV / Résumé

- Personal Information
- Objective
- Previous work Experience
- Education

- Skills and Abilities
- Other Certifications
- Honors
- Publications
- Presentations
- Professional Membership
- Courses/Trainings attended (Professional/Other)

Additional Information

- Objective/Professional interest statement
- Computer/Technical Skills
- Additional Experience
- Committees
- Community Server/Volunteer
- Foreign Languages
- Interest /Hobbies

Parts of a Résumé

There are some standard parts on which a resume should be designed. Some of the most important parts of a resume:

- 1) **Headings/Personal Information:** The sender's detail is the first thing that an employer wants to know.
 - Always put on the top
 - Your Name
 - ✓ Must be the first line of CV
 - ✓ Bold
 - ✓ Larger than the largest font used in body
 - Photograph (Use A Professional Photo)
 - Contact Information
 - ✓ Mobile No
 - ✓ Email Address
- 2) **Career objectives:** The purpose of resume is to generate interest immediately and a statement of careerobjective may attract the employer at once.
 - Statement must be clear, concise and to the point
 - i. Bad: *"I want to get a job"*
 - ii. Weak: *"To attain an internship in livestock industry."*
 - iii. Good: *"To attain an internship in the livestock industry with*

detailed insight into genomics and bioinformatics.”

- Avoid being over specific
- Target the company's perspective

3) Education: If education is the applicant's strongest point, it should be discussed thoroughly. Education is considered the strongest selling point.

- Start from Last School attended
- Write Course/Degree Name
- Year of Passing
- CGPA/% obtained

4) Work experience: This part of the CV/ Resume provides an overview of the applicant's professional experience. Work experience should be written with proper emphasis. Details of the section will be based on the points, listed below:

- a) Name of the location of employer*
- b) Post on which the applicant has worked*
- c) How long he worked there*
- d) His duties and responsibilities in bullets*
- e) His achievements or his contribution*
- f) Experience should be listed in reverse chronological order*
- g) Don't be over descriptive*

5) Special qualification or Skills: Those special qualifications which can be valuable to an employer are given in this section in a CV. All of them important. Highlight the skills most relevant to the job.

6) Project Experience: It should focus on relevant project experience. The graduate level projects must be included in it. It must be in reverse chronological order.

7) Extra-Curricular Activities: It may also include extra-curricular awards. It should include a brief description if not self-evident from title. It is good to include leadership positions. It should scream -I am a leader|. Do not include hobbies or activities not related to the job or your story.

8) Achievements and awards: It must contain all academic and professional awards.

9) Strengths: Strengths are things you are best at, traits or capabilities that make you excel at your work. Employers are not interested only in candidates who simply know how to do certain things. When deciding who to put on the shortlist, they have specific strengths in mind. In other words, they need someone who excels at particular abilities.

10) Personal details: DOB, Father's name, Nationality, Marital status, Languages known.

11) References: Some employers need references from persons who know the applicant's work and the professional competence.

- Follow the requirement
- **If not mentioned, then "On Request/demand"**
- Ask referees beforehand
- Use the best ones.
- Carefully choose someone who know you and likes you
- Credible and competent
- For each referee, list: Name, Title, Organization, Business address, Phone number and email

12) Declaration: A declaration in a resume states that all the information you have included is correct to the best of your knowledge.

13) Date, Place and Signature

Types of CV/ **Résumé**

Chronological: This is the most common style, in which the personal details, along with the academic record are stated plainly in a chronological order; quite often it is reverse chronological order. It is mainly used by individuals with:-

- Solid work history
- Few or no gaps between jobs

2) Functional: It does not just mention the duration of work; it emphasizes more upon the quality of work, and special accomplishments of the applicant.

3) Chrono-functional/Combinational/Combined: It is a fusion of the best characteristics of chronological and functional resume. It not only highlights the quality of a candidate's special skills, but gives account of his personal details, academic record and experience. It is used mainly by individuals:-

- Freshly graduated from school
- With uninterrupted work history
- Applying for specific jobs

Styles of CV/ Résumé

Electronic CVs

a) Email Attachment

- Currently the most widely used delivery method
- PDF most widely used format
- Easily convert your Microsoft Word CV to PDF using various online resources

b) HTML Resume

- Shows your creativity
- Easily available and free of cost from many service providers like google
- Link to different sections of your CV
- Very detailed
- You can add forms of social media like twitter, facebook pages and personal/professional blogs

Scannable/ Paper Résumé

- Best to use black color fonts
- Use proper font type (do not try anything fancy)
- Many companies scan paper resumes into their database

Interview Skills

An interview is usually called a formal meeting. It provides an opportunity to the participants to exchange views and also to evaluate others.

Job interviews should be a process of two-way communication. Not only are they a tool for employers to use to evaluate you, but they are also an opportunity for you to assess the job, the organization, and to see if there is a "fit."

The keys to a successful interview are preparation and practice.

Purposes of an Interview

- The applicant's objective is to find the job best suited to his goal.
- To find the best person available for the job.

Types of Interviews

Interviews give you an opportunity to impress employers with your knowledge and personality. Interviewers ask candidates different questions to assess their suitability for a given position. Depending on the type of job and the stage of the recruitment process, companies may use different types of interviews to narrow down their search. There are 10 different types of interviews along with actionable tips to increase your chances of success in each type.

What Are The Main Types Of Interviews?

Employers use many different types of interviews to evaluate candidates. In most cases, they would tell you in advance what type of interview to expect. Here are the 10 most common interview types employers use for recruitment:

Face-to-face interviews

A face-to-face interview is one in which you and the interviewer meet in person to discuss your credentials. The interviewer can be the employer, manager, someone from the HR department or a third party recruitment consultant hired by the company. The interview usually takes place on the company premises. After asking general questions related to your skills, education and experience, the interviewer usually proceeds to

assess your subject matter expertise.

Tips for preparing

Research the company and their work culture while preparing for these interviews. Understanding the company's business model and work ethics well can give you an advantage over other candidates. Another important aspect to keep in mind while attending face-to-face interviews is your body language. The way you walk, sit and speak communicates your personality to the interviewer. Be confident and comfortable while attending the interview. Use this personal meeting as an opportunity to leave a positive impression on the interviewer.

Panel interviews

In a panel interview, you would be facing questions from multiple interviewers. The interview panel may include people from different departments or disciplines. The panel usually takes a collective decision about your selection for the job. For example, an interview panel may include a project lead, HR manager and subject matter expert. The project lead may focus on your suitability for the team, the HR manager may evaluate you in terms of your salary expectations and long-term career goals, and the subject matter expert may test your subject knowledge.

Tips for preparing

In a panel interview, you are required to impress all the interviewers to increase your chances of selection. Greet the panel members when you enter the interview room. Make eye contact with all the panel members during the interview. But, direct your response to the interviewer who asked you the question. Ensure that your answers to questions and counter questions from different interviewers are consistent.

Group interviews

In this type of interview, companies interview several candidates simultaneously. Companies mostly use group interviews when they require to recruit multiple candidates in a short period of time. The interviewer may ask questions to the entire group at a time or may ask each candidate to answer individually. They may also ask you to interact with other candidates or may even give you a task to perform in a team to assess your communication, interpersonal and teamwork skills.

For example, the interviewer may ask all the candidates present to divide themselves into several small teams. Each team may require to interact with its members to understand one another. After giving some time to spend together, the interviewer may ask each candidate for their opinion on who would be a good leader for their team and why.

Tips for preparing

In a group interview, look for ways to make yourself stand out from others. Whenever required, express your opinion clearly and confidently. Listen carefully when others are

speaking. Respect others' opinions and be polite to other candidates. Try to present yourself as a positive individual with a problem-solving attitude.

Telephonic interviews

Companies often use a telephonic interview to shortlist candidates for a subsequent face-to-face interview. When there are multiple rounds of interviews planned for a position, companies may conduct the telephonic interview in the first round. They may ask you some basic questions like your background and why you applied for the position. If they decide to move further with your selection, they may call you for a face-to-face interview.

In some types of jobs like telemarketing, receptionist and voice-based call centre positions, companies may require to assess your telephone skills. In such cases, companies may use the telephonic interview as an additional round for finalising the candidates. Similarly, in the case of remote positions, a telephonic interview may serve as a formal interview.

Tips for preparing

The advantage in the case of a telephonic interview is that you can refer to notes during the interview. But, try to prepare for it as you would for a formal face-to-face interview. Remember that you are required to express yourself only through your voice unlike in the case of a face-to-face interview, where gestures and body language serve as an additional means of communication. Hence, make sure that you speak clearly at a good pace without any long pauses. Try to find a quiet and distraction-free place for the interview.

Video interviews

Companies usually conduct video interviews for remote positions or in cases where it is not possible for the candidates to attend an interview in person. You can attend a video interview using a PC, laptop or smartphone. You may require to install the teleconferencing application your employer uses for the interview.

Tips for preparing

In terms of interview questions, you can prepare for a video interview just like you would do for a traditional face-to-face interview. Dress professionally in clean and tidy clothes. Have a steady internet connection with reasonably good speed. Find a quiet place with a neutral backdrop and organise your workstation well.

Off-site interviews

Off-site interviews are mostly informal in nature. The recruitment manager may invite you for a personal meeting over lunch or dinner. Your etiquette and personality may be more in focus during these types of interviews. The interviewer may observe you and assess your interpersonal skills and table manners.

Tips for preparing

Although the interviewer may try to make you feel comfortable by creating an informal atmosphere, be sure to act professionally. If you require to order the food, choose something that would allow you to have a conversation while eating. Be careful to eat and drink properly without spilling on the dress or table.

Stress interviews

Companies use stress interviews to see how a candidate reacts in a stressful situation. You may encounter this type of interview if you are applying for a high-stress position. The interviewer may try to assess your ability to solve challenging problems, work in a multi-tasking environment or deal with clients that are difficult to handle.

Tips for preparing

To create a stressful situation, the interviewer may ask you unusual questions, interrupt frequently, increase the pace of the interview, get rude with you, behave unusually or ask you to perform an odd task. You may feel uncomfortable or intimidated but be sure to remain calm, handle the situation gracefully and focus on solving the problem.

Prepare for some common stress interview questions and comments like:

- *I do not think you are suitable for this position.*
- *What would you do if you were caught stealing?*
- *How would you sell this item to a customer?*
- *That is a stereotypical answer. Tell me something new.*

Take the time to breathe, regain composure and maintain your own pace. Try to keep smiling and remain cheerful throughout the interview.

Structured interviews

In a structured interview, the interviewer asks the same set of questions to all the candidates. The interviewer then compares the responses of the candidates to find the suitable one. The questions you encounter in a structured interview can either be open-ended or close-ended. In the case of close-ended questions, you usually require to choose the right answer from a list of alternatives. Open-ended questions can have several different answers and may allow you to elaborate your response.

Tips for preparing

The easiest way to prepare for a structured interview is to look for common questions asked in such interviews and think of the answers beforehand. Ask yourself what skills you possess that can help you excel in the given position.

Unstructured interviews

In an unstructured interview, the interviewer may change the questions and ask follow-up questions based on your response. They may have a few pre-determined questions in mind but may modify them or add more questions based on how the interview progresses.

Tips for preparing

To do well in an unstructured interview, prepare for the common types of questions related to your area of expertise. Instead of memorising the answers, focus on understanding the logic behind them.

Case interviews

In a case interview, the interviewer gives you a problem or explains a situation and asks you to provide a solution. The problem or the situation given can be an imaginary one or based on a real-life experience. The idea is to test your problem-solving aptitude at work.

Tips for preparing

Listen patiently and pay attention to the details. Analyse the given situation and try to give a practical solution that would be apt for the given scenario.

Preparation of Interview

Before the interview

- **Research the Company**

A company's website is an excellent place to begin. It usually gives you information on whether it is international or domestic, what its revenues are, how many locations it has, and the nature of its major products. Most companies are very proud of their websites.

- **Practice interviews**

Write down a list of possible questions that you think may be asked, then have a friend act as an interviewer and direct them to you in a practice interview situation. Don't stop until you feel comfortable answering each question. Practicing beforehand will make you feel more comfortable and relaxed during the interview.

- **Dress Professionally**

In today's environment, wearing a suit isn't always necessary. Contact the HR Manager of the company or your recruiter, and find out what the dress code is for the company at which you are going to interview. Then dress one level above.

- **Arrival**

Try to arrive at the interview location a little early. This gives you time to determine where you need to go, and will give you a few minutes to collect your thoughts. DO NOT arrive late. Nothing destroys your chance at impressing an employer more than

arriving late and offering no explanation. If you learn at the last minute that you are going to be arriving late at the interview, call and let the interviewer know. Interviewers understand that things can come up suddenly. You are never considered late if you call and make them aware of the fact.

During the Interview

- **First impressions**

First impressions take only thirty seconds. Establishing rapport, direct and sustained eye contact, a firm handshake, a warm smile, good posture, and introducing yourself in a confident manner are important ingredients. A well-groomed, professional appearance is critical. Greet the interviewer with a firm handshake, whether it is a woman or a man. (No one likes a weak handshake.) Always maintain eye contact while shaking hands.

- **Smile**

A smile denotes confidence in a candidate. Try to smile often. Also, don't be afraid to use some hand animation while answering questions. This suggests enthusiasm in a candidate.

- **Know Your Resume**

Be prepared to talk about every fact that is on your resume. Many people embellish their accomplishments on their resumes. Avoid this, since the only point of reference an interviewer has about you is the resume you provide to him/her beforehand.

- **Body Language**

Use good posture, and look the interviewer right in the eye. Sit up straight. Never slouch.

- **Speak Clearly**

Don't mumble. It portrays a lack of confidence. Speak with assurance. This indicates confidence.

- **Be Truthful**

Don't lie when asked about something you haven't done. The next question will be "tell us about it."

After the Interview

- **Back in Touch**

Ask the interviewer when s/he expects to get back to you on her/his decision.

- **Get Everyone's Business Card**

Before you leave, be sure to get the business cards of all of the people with whom you visited. If you cannot do that, ask a secretary for their names and e-mail addresses.

- **Thank the Interviewer**

Verbally thank the interviewer for taking the time to interview you, before leaving.

Within a day, send

thank-you letters to all of the interviewers with whom you spoke. This does not need to consist of a written letter sent via snail mail; an e-mailed thank-you works just as well.

- **Do not give up**

Sometimes, within ten minutes of the start of an interview, you will know that the job is not one you want to pursue. If you begin to feel this way, don't give up on the interview. Continue to interview as if the job was the most important thing in the world. This provides you with practice for your next interview, which may be for your dream job! Not all interviews will lead to offers of employment, but, if you approach every interview as if it's the most important interview you ever had, you will come out a winner!

Additional tips

- Focus on presenting a positive, enthusiastic tone.
- If you are asked to describe a weakness, mention lessons learned, and steer away from negative descriptions.
- Think about three or four key points that you want to make about your personal characteristics, skills you have learned, and relevant experiences that demonstrate that you could perform the job well.
- Find specific, rather than general, examples from your experience that illustrate important points about yourself.
- When answering questions, focus on experiences that demonstrate flexibility, adaptability, responsibility, progress, achievement, creativity, initiative, and leadership.
- If the employer signals the end of the interview and asks you for questions, and you haven't discussed some key points, say: "There are a couple of points I would like to mention."
- After the interview, write a brief thank you letter. Express your appreciation for the opportunity to interview and learn about the organization, re-confirm your interest, and re-emphasize how your background and skills might be of interest to the organization.

Group Discussion

Meaning of Group Definition

Group discussion is formed by combining two different words i.e. group and discussion. Here, group means a number of people or things that are put together considered as a unit whereas

the word ‘discuss’ is derived from the Latin ‘discutere’, which means to shake or strike.

Thus ‘discussion’ refers to examine the topic thoroughly to reach a conclusion. Collectively, it is called Group discussion which means the exchange of ideas by participated candidates on a specific subject or topic. The whole concept is to bring collectively a unit of people on a common platform to share their ideas.

Generally, group discussion is a method used by the companies or organizations to check whether the candidates have certain personality or skills which are must for their members or employees. Nowadays, group discussions have become a main stage in the recruitment process.

Group discussion also tells about how candidates behave, participate and contribute in a group. Also, recruiters come to know about how much importance applicants give to the team objectives as well as their own, how well they listen to viewpoints of others and how open-minded are they in accepting the views contrary to their own

Improve Interest in Lessons: It improves How is it conducted?

- A typical GD comprises of a small group of candidates i.e. 8 to 12 members
- Students sit in a circular or C shape arrangement
- Each group is then given a topic for discussion
- Students are given a paper and pen and 2 minutes to think before they start discussing
- A GD should last not more than 15-20 minutes

Types of GD

- Factual Topics
- Abstract Topics
- Controversial Topics
- Case Study based

Salient features/nature of G.D

- Group discussion is basically an interactive process which provides an opportunity to the participants to express their view and feeling orally.
- It is a group process. It provides an opportunity to person-to-group interaction
- It is a productive activity. It is a goal oriented activity.
- Group discussion is a planned activity.
- Topic may be given to judge your public speaking talent.
- Discussion revolves around a specific subject.
- The examiner does not interfere once he announced the topic.

Maintain cordiality and free expression of thought and opinion.

Importance or Objectives of Group Discussion in Education and Learning

Group discussion plays a vital role in a student's life. Group discussions in the classroom are not only beneficial for a student's social skills only but also enhance their educational development and learning too. Nowadays group discussion plays a key role in selecting the best among the best. It is one of the best tools to study the behavioural and attitudinal responses of the applicants or the candidates. With the help of group discussion, many things for a particular candidate can be assessed, such as his/her mental capacity to think, creative mind, analytical abilities, comprehending a subject and then speaking on it, awareness, attitude, and energy levels.

- **Enhance Critical Thinking:** Group discussion is used in a classroom to improve learning, asking open-ended questions will encourage critical thinking and help students think for themselves
- **Help with Understanding:** Group discussion use to help students to understand a topic or concept deeply which will stay for a long time in their minds.
- **Improve Communication Skills:** It is also used to improve communication skills as it can encourage students to become more confident in speaking up and asking questions. This will help them improve their communication in the long run because it should make them more confident to ask if they're stuck and need help.
- **Provide the Feedback:** When learners discuss and explain the concepts to each other aloud in a group, it helps the teacher to hear if they have learnt a concept or not. This is a perfect feedback on teaching. It means that, if the teacher sees that they don't understand something clearly, they can help them by stepping in and adding some more context or information in their discussion.
- **Productive activity:** Group discussion is always supposed to be a productive activity in a business concern.

Benefits of Group Discussion

- Stimulation of thinking in a new way
- Expansion of knowledge
- Understanding of your strength and weakness.
- Your true personality is revealed and qualities of leadership crystallize
- Provides chance to Expose
- Language skills
- Academic knowledge
- Leadership skills
- People handling skills
- Team work
- General knowledge

What is judged?

- How good you are at communication with others.
- How you behave and interact with group.
- How open minded are you.
- Your listening skill.
- How you put forward your views.
- Your leadership and decision making skills.
- Your analysis skill and subject knowledge.
- Problem solving and critical thinking skill.
- Your attitude and confidence.
- Your team building skills
- Out of the box thinking

Tips/Important points in group discussion

- 1) **Be assertive:** An assertive person is direct, honest careful about not hurting others =self-respect ‘.
- 2) **Keep eye contact while speaking:** Do not look at the evaluators only. Keep eye contact with every teammember while speaking.
- 3) **Initiate the GD:** Initiating the GD is a big plus. But keep in mind – Initiate the group discussion only when you understood the GD topic clearly and have some topic knowledge. Speaking without proper subject knowledge is bad impression.
- 4) **Allow others to speak:** Do not interrupt anyone in-between while speaking. Even if you don't agree with his/her thoughts do not snatch their chance to speak. Instead make some notes and clear the points when it's your turn.
- 5) **A patient listener:** Speak less and listen more! Pay attention while others are speaking. This will make coherent discussion and you will get involved in the group positively. You will surely make people agree with you.
- 6) **Speak clearly:** Speak politely and clearly. Use simple and understandable words while speaking. Don't

be too aggressive if you are disagreeing with someone. Express your feelings calmly and politely.

- 7) **Speak sensibly:** Do not speak just to increase your speaking time. Don't worry even if you speak less. Your thoughts should be sensible and relevant instead of irrelevant speech.
- 8) **Be analytical and fact-oriented:** It is necessary to make relevant points which can be supported with facts and analyzed logically.

- 9) **Accept criticism:** If any member of the group criticizes or disapproves a point, it is unwise to get upset or react sharply. In case the criticism is flimsy, the same can be pointed out politely.
- 10) **Maximize participation:** one must try to contribute fully, vigorously & steadily throughout the discussion.
- 11) **Show leadership ability:** A group discussion also evaluates your leadership qualities.
- 12) **Make sure to bring the discussion on track:** If by any means group is distracting from the topic or goal then simply take initiative to bring the discussion on the track. Make all group members aware that you all need to come to some conclusion at the end of the discussion. So stick to the topic.
- 13) **Positive attitude:** Be confident. Do not try to dominate anyone. Keep positive body language. Show interest in discussion.

Use statements like

- -I agree with my friend that...||
- -I'd like to add a point to what my friend said...||
- -I would further like to add something to....||
- -Sorry, but I beg to differ...||
- -In my opinion... ||
- -According to (state source/facts/stats)...||
- -I think we are diverting away from the subject...||
- -Please allow our friend ____who has been trying to say something a chance||
- -I request _____to give his/her opinion on...||

Initiation Techniques

- State the topic
- Quote
- Definition
- Question
- Shock Statement
- Facts, figures & statistics
- Initiate a GD only when you have understood the topic & have a valid point
- Don't start a GD just for the heck of it
- Opening sentence should lead the GD
- Keep it brief

How to summarize?

- If the moderator asks you to summarize a GD, it means the GD has come to an end.
- Avoid raising new points

- Avoid stating only your viewpoint
- Avoid dwelling only on one aspect of the GD.
- Keep it brief and concise
- It must incorporate all the important points that came out during the GD.
- Do not add anything once the GD has been summarized.

Summary/ Conclusion

- Begin with, -In a nutshell..|| or -To summarize...||
- State group opinions not just your opinion
- Incorporate all the major points
- Keep it brief
- If a consensus then conclude with one
- If mixed opinions then take a poll by a raise of hands/yes-no & conclude
- End GD after summary

Do's in group discussion

- Be a good listener
- Do not use high vocabulary
- Appropriate to the issue
- Make original points and support them by substantial reasoning
- Listen to the other participants actively and carefully
- Whatever you say must be with a logical flow and validate it with an example as far as possible
- Make only accurate statements
- Modulate the volume, pitch and tone
- Be considerate to the feelings of the others
- Talk with confidence and self-assurance
- Speak pleasantly and politely to the group
- Respect the contribution of every speaker
- Remember that a discussion is not an argument
- Learn to disagree politely
- Think about your contribution before you speak
- Be aware of your body language when you are speaking

Don'ts during group discussion

- Do not get personal with anyone
- Never ever try to bluff
- Do not be shy /nervous / keep yourself isolated from G.D

- Don't make fun of any participant even if his arguments are funny.
- Don't engage yourself in sub-group conversation.
- Do not get irritated
- Don't lose your temper
- A discussion is not an argument.
- Don't shout. Use a moderate tone and medium pitch.
- Don't use too many gestures when you speak. Gestures like finger pointing and table thumping can appear aggressive.
- Don't dominate the discussion. Confident speakers should allow quieter students a chance to contribute.
- Don't interrupt. Wait for a speaker to finish what they are saying before you speak.
- Don't worry about making some grammatical mistakes, for your interest the matter you put across are important

Effective Profiling

What Is A Personal Profile For A CV?

A personal profile for a CV lets hiring managers know about the most important aspects of your professional and educational experience. Unlike other parts of your resume, which you can alter for a specific job, you might keep this short description the same. It may seem like a simple task, but it does require some thought. You can think about why a hiring manager might choose you for an interview. You may find some reflection can help you to include a wide range of information that clearly shows why you would be the best candidate.

Your personal profile is one of the first things that a hiring manager may see on your resume. Make sure that it is short and includes your educational background, skills and a summary of your relevant experience. This is a great way to capture a recruiter's attention and help them understand why you would be a preferred candidate over the others. As an entry-level candidate, you may want to include your career goals in this section. If you are a seasoned professional, you could highlight your work experiences and significant achievements throughout your career.

How To Write A Personal Profile For A CV

The following steps can help show you how to write a personal profile for a CV that is clear and compelling:

1. Summarise your career stage

Use this section to highlight where you are in your career. For recent graduates, you may mention that you have recently completed your education along with your area of study. Entry-level candidates may share their short-term experiences, such as trainee or intern positions. More experienced candidates may summarise their previous work and designation.

2. Highlight your pertinent skills

You may use this section to give the hiring manager an idea of your strongest skills that would be pertinent to the role you are applying for. A great way to highlight this is by using impactful words such as *highly organised*, *detail oriented* or *self-motivated*.

3. Mention your education and experience

The job you have applied for may require that you meet certain criteria. To demonstrate that you are an eligible applicant, you may mention your degree, your vocational training and certifications and your previous work experience.

4. Describe your career goals

An important factor to mention in your personal profile is your career goals. This helps the hiring manager understand your dedication to your work responsibilities. It also helps demonstrate how you may contribute to the company's goals.

Tips To Write A Personal Profile

To increase your chances of success against other candidates and get an interview, here are some tips to craft your personal profile:

Keep it short

A personal profile provides a quick overview of your professional experience as a potential candidate for the company you are applying to. So, personal profiles that perform well are generally three to five sentences long. It is best if you can share certain highlights in a single sentence rather than two, as it gives you more space on your resume for other important information. The more concise the personal profile is, the better it may communicate your message.

Customise it for the role

While most of the personal profile remains the same across applications, you may want to customise it according to the role. You might do this only when the changes present you as a better candidate. A way to customise your personal profile is by reviewing the keywords in the

job description you are applying for and then changing words to match. This may capture a hiring manager's attention more easily.

Use a professional format

It is important to create a personal profile that leaves a strong impression on the hiring manager, but it is equally important to ensure that it looks professional. You may use corporate fonts like Times New Roman, Proxima Nova or Helvetica for a professional look. You may also use a second font to pair with the primary font. You can even italicise or bold statements to make them appear more prominent and draw attention to those sections.

Another way to look professional and create an impression is by mixing colours to highlight important sections. Use corporate colours such as black, navy blue, dark grey or blue green. It is best to use a maximum of two colours in your resume.

Avoid corporate jargon

It is best to stay away from industry jargon or even acronyms. What you intend to communicate versus what a standardised version of the acronym means could be different and cause confusion for the hiring manager. The use of technical jargon may also not add value since you do not know who is initially screening your resume. If they are not an expert, you may miss an opportunity. By being clear and engaging, you may increase your chances of getting an interview.

Add important numbers

Since your personal profile section is short, you can try to avoid using general phrases other applicants might include on their resumes. You can be strategic about what to share that may make you appear as a strong candidate. You can add achievements, such as receiving a particular award, or factual numbers, such as increasing sales by a specific percentage, which might help you get an interview.

Remember to proofread

Carefully review your profile to ensure that there are no spelling or grammar mistakes and that it is easy to understand. You can rewrite sentences as necessary but try not to overuse contractions. You may even get it checked by friends or family to be sure that there are no errors in your personal profile and resume.

Examples Of A Personal Profile

Here are a few examples you may review before creating your own personal profile:

- *A competent content marketing manager with over five years of experience, looking to leverage demonstrated marketing and strategy skills to increase your company's revenue.*

I have previously exceeded revenue targets for a fast-paced marketing start-up company. I have also led multi-functional teams of eight or more people and increased work output by 34%, resulting in cost savings of 5.3 lakhs per year.

- An innovative visual designer with over three years of work experience in medium-sized companies. I have worked on over 30 client projects and managed a team of two. I am skilled at using desktop publishing software. I am seeking to leverage my skills to work on branding and website design projects for your company.*
- A detail-oriented computer science professional with over six years of experience working at major tech firms. I am proficient in five programming languages. I am looking to make use of my robust programming and managerial skills for your company and grow the team further.*
- A local-based business development executive with a background in lead generation and sales for marketing and advertising agencies. I am skilled in negotiation, verbal and written communication, time management and organisation. I expanded the previous company's business by 41% during my two-year tenure. I am looking to leverage my sales and management skills to increase your company's revenue and incorporate efficient working structures.*
- I am a recent graduate of PCU, and I am looking to begin my journey in human resources at small- to medium-sized companies. I can assist in the recruitment process and set up of workflow structures to increase productivity across the company. My organisation skills along with my previous internship experience make me an ideal candidate for the role of a junior human resources executive.*

Communication and Networking: Building Relationships

Introduction:

- Effective communication is the cornerstone of successful relationships in the business world.
- Networking is a critical skill that involves building and maintaining relationships for personal and professional growth.
- This lecture will explore the fundamental principles of communication and networking in the context of business.

What is networking?

Networking is about building long-term business relationships that are beneficial to both parties. When networking, you meet and get to know people who not only offer career advice or guidance, but can help expand your effectiveness in your organization. Networking creates the right connections with the right people and fosters those relationships regularly.

In business, networking is important because it:

Builds your reputation

Builds trust and support

Invites opportunity

Inspires creative thinking

Related: [The Complete Guide To Networking](#)

[14 reasons to start networking](#)

We compiled 14 reasons why networking can benefit you in business.

1. It increases business connections

Meeting like-minded people in the same or similar industries introduces you to others with similar goals. Sharing ideas and solutions with others can help you achieve your career goals and provide evidence of your expertise. A network becomes a pool of resources you can turn to to solve problems or exchange ideas. As a bonus, networking can produce lifelong friendships.

2. You find inspiration

Sharing challenges, experiences or goals with others allows for an exchange of ideas or insight. When others offer input it may result in an influx of new perspectives not considered before. When you're the one offering advice, others may see you as knowledgeable or reliable, which builds your reputation and increases the chance that others might turn to you in the future.

3. You are visible

Being visible isn't about showing up at every event, it's about demonstrating that you are a reliable and supportive member of your profession. As you network effectively, you become a familiar face who is easily recognized. People may want to get to know you, giving you an opportunity to showcase your skills and discuss what you have to offer. Being visible increases the chance you'll stand out as a candidate, especially if you're looking for new job opportunities.

4. It enhances career interests

Networking advances career interests by introducing you to people who can provide advice for career advancement like proofreading a resume or cover letter or practicing interview questions. Or, you may meet mentors in the same industry who can offer advice on asking for a raise or promotion.

5. It creates job opportunities

In some cases, available jobs aren't listed on a company's careers page and require inside knowledge. Your networking relationships might inform you of unadvertised job openings or

even refer you. Be sure to let your network know if you're looking for a new job so they can offer chances for career advancement or personal growth.

For people who run their own business, networking can expose you to new clients or business investment advice. If you're doing the hiring, networking might provide the ideal candidate.

6. You know more

Networking creates access to new and valuable information, especially when it comes from a wide array of knowledgeable people. You may hear about new developments or learn techniques others are using in your industry. Try pursuing contacts you can learn and grow from to stay ahead of your competition.

7. You find career advice and support

Meeting people with common challenges may provide valuable suggestions or advice for an approach you hadn't considered before. Networking can introduce you to mentors who can provide professional critiques and help you achieve your career goals.

8. You build self-confidence

Networking boosts self-confidence and develops social skills. Striking up conversations with people you don't know lets you grow to become self-assured and comfortable. Forming business relationships can strengthen other office, professional and personal relationships by developing people skills.

Related: [How To Network if You're an Introvert](#)

9. You might consider a different approach

Sometimes it is difficult to see a problem, especially if you've tried to find a solution for a while. Turn to your network to help you look at the situation from a different angle. Fresh eyes may see an alternate solution or help you overcome roadblocks. Asking your network for opinions or advice conveys trust and helps to develop long-term relationships.

10. You get answers to questions

Networks can help answer tough questions and form action plans to overcome a hurdle or meet a benchmark. Asking industry-related questions might provide information on new business trends, or you may hear an industry tip on a new piece of cutting-edge technology. Asking questions yields answers that might give you an advantage over your competition.

11. You may find personal solutions

Your network is valuable in aspects other than business. Perhaps you plan to remodel your bathroom in the spring and a networking event introduces you to a reputable contractor.

Your network is a resource for people who can provide services to you personally and hiring them can boost your professional relationship.

12. You develop long-lasting relationships

Networking introduces you to like-minded professionals who may also share your common interests. Interacting with peers or industry professionals can often help you develop significant relationships for sharing goals and aspirations. Your network may introduce you to people with whom you form deeper friendships where you can support each other professionally and personally.

13. It has positive health effects

Forming bonds increases your mental and physical health. As you build relationships, you establish a sense of worth and value. Providing advice to others and helping them succeed can give you an emotional boost. Relationship building requires several soft skills, such as communication and teamwork, that strengthen each time you network.

14. You can follow your dream

Networking is an opportunity to find a job you'll love. You may meet people who are hiring for the ideal job or offering an internship or apprenticeship. Your network may alert you to new job opportunities or refer you to hiring managers. Be sure your network knows what you're looking for and what you bring to the job.

Related: [Networking Resumes: How To Create a Resume To Build Your Professional Network](#)

[Upgrade your resume](#)

[Showcase your skills with help from a resume expert](#)

[How to network effectively](#)

Networking is ongoing, rather than taking place exclusively at an event. Building networks takes time, patience and consistency.

Tips to effectively build your network:

1. Look for professional and social opportunities

Business events are just one networking opportunity, consider the many places you interact with other people. As you meet others, share what you do or what job you're looking for. Be sure to tailor your approach to the formality of the event.

2. Plan ahead

Before you attend an event or gathering, find out who will be at the event and perform research if needed. Have questions or topics ready for whomever you've decided to approach. Remember to include topics of common, non-business interests such as hobbies or pastimes. Have business cards ready to hand out and create a system for remembering or filing contacts with appropriate details such as company, contact information and how you met.

3. Leave a positive impression

Optimistic people make a good impression and those who display excitement about what they do can inspire others. Apply active listening when speaking to someone and repeat their question or dilemma back to them. Others are more likely to respond well or remember you if

you seem interested and respond in an informed and thoughtful way.

4. Follow up and follow through

If you made a promise, follow through; follow up if an offer was made to or by you. Return phone calls or answer emails and texts promptly. Above all, consistently demonstrate and uphold your business standards to build an effective and positive network.